



Simple four-bar mechanisms can be adapted to a wide range of diverse purposes.

Similarly, more complex motions have been developed, such as the crank-rocker mechanism that produces an angular oscillatory push, and the quick-return mechanism that can save time on the return stroke of a power machine.

What it does - functions and end effectors

The ultimate function of most robots is concentrated in a particularly crucial part. This is often an extremity - rarely is a robot found that uses the bulk of its body to perform work, as that would be both inaccurate and clumsy. End-effectors are the tools fixed at the end of a robot's limbs that are used to perform the true function, so to speak, of the robot. Perhaps the most general end-effector is the gripper, which may have zero or more degrees of freedom.



A six-axis FANUC welding robot with the end effectors clearly visible